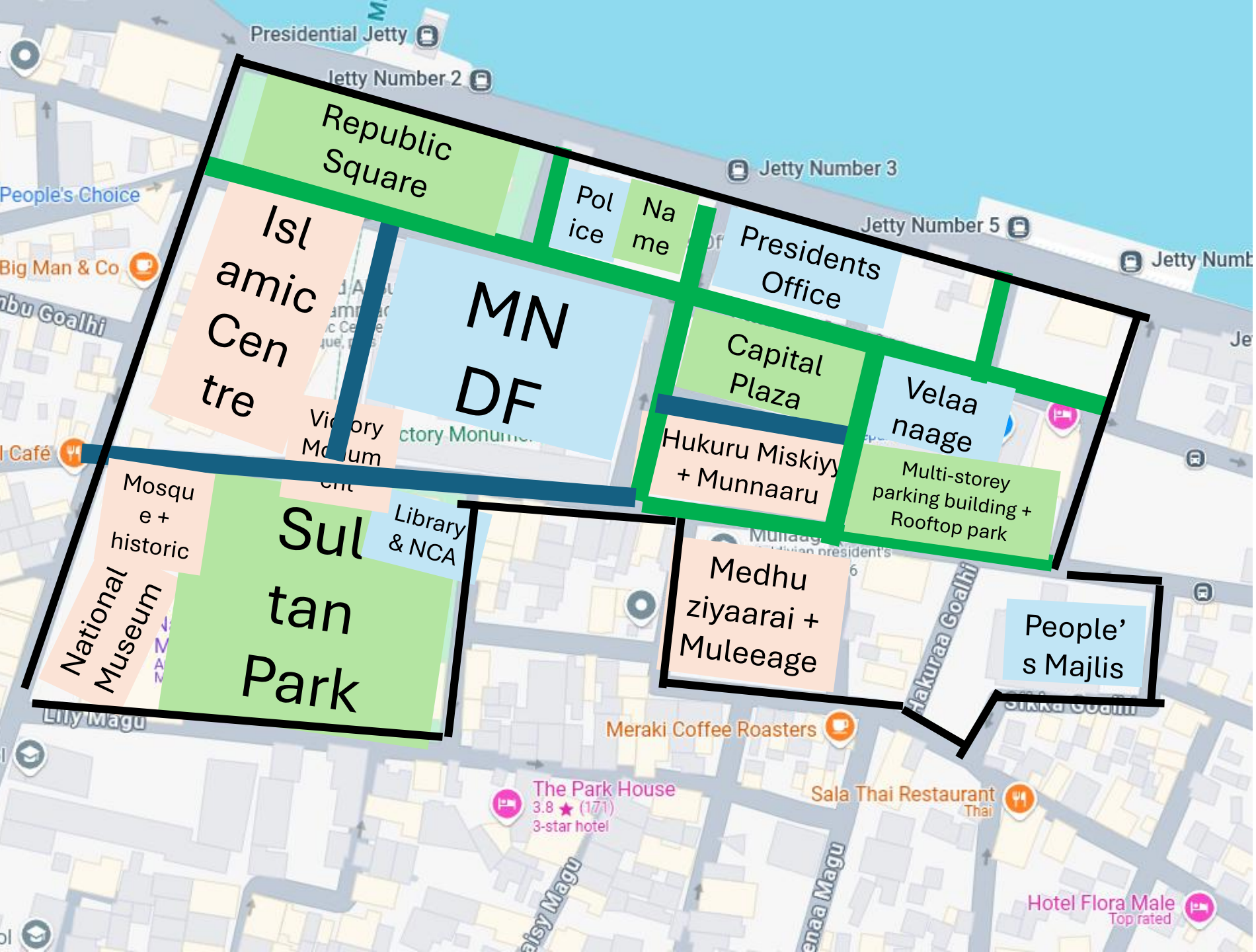
Old Male’ City & Capital District

CONCEPT



- Black line: outline of Old City to become a preserved and tourist site
- Dark blue lines: already pedestrian walkways with trees, shade, and no vehicles
- Dark green lines: can be gradually turned one by one over time to shaded pedestrian walkways with trees
- Light green squares: park spaces (including new Capital Plaza where PO, Velaanaage ministries, and Majlis staff can rest and build efficient ties, while also being a big tourist attraction)
- Blue squares: government buildings
- Peach squares: historical or cultural sites

Old City

Memorable tourist attraction and reason for tourists going to resorts to also visit Male' (similar districts exist in other cities so familiar concept for tourists)

Having a "capital district" or "capital complex" where the government agencies are a collective complex and PO, Velaanaage and Majlis feel like a whole that works together

Locals to feel more in touch with Male' history (more able to understand how it used to be vs reclaimed and highly developed locations)

Capital Plaza

- Huravee Building sites can be made into a beautiful shaded park and public square which brings everything together, especially the space between the three buildings
- That space includes Hukuru Miskiyy which puts the oldest symbol of the city and traditions at the heart of government symbolically
- People spending time in the square will be seeing the old and the new of the city all together
- Unique design elements that appeal to tourists and locals
- One of the first things any tourist coming to Male' will see

Pedestrian-friendly

- About 35% of the streets within this area are already vehicle-free pedestrian areas
- Already pedestrian: walkway between Islamic Centre and MNDF, area between Islamic Centre and Sultan Park, sand pathway between Hukuru Miskiyy and old Huravee building area (“Capital Plaza”, etc
- Gradually making remaining streets in the zone pedestrian-only
- Ameer Ahmed Magu area outside PO and street next to Majlis already has lots of trees and easy to make pedestrian-only

Accessible transport

- Can create direct bus routes from across city and Hulhumale to directly by this area to encourage government employees to use public transport even for their own convenience
- Can have the e-bike docking stations and charging stations later to encourage all the core government employees to conveniently use e-bikes
- Lots of indoor parking in multi-storey building with a rooftop park in current Majlis parking area behind Hotel Jen (eventually)
- Pedestrian walkways are more wheelchair-friendly than roads

Affordable, impactful, legacy

- Lasting legacy “built the city as we know it”
- This area would become symbolic of the city the way Buckingham Palace is for London, Capitol Building/White House is for Washington DC, etc
- Pedestrian streets is one of the lower-cost options for city redevelopment + is a good first step for other things like with streetscaping, shade structures, art projects, and other elements
- People will complain about driving streets for a while but will forget about it and appreciate the area in months

Streamlined policy

Ghaazee building area flooring needs to be renovated anyway so might as well make it a park

Tree-planting and streetscaping already promised

Becomes a valuable social third-space for all ages

City e-bike system already promised and a suitable area to encourage its use needed

Multi-storey parking near key buildings already planned so Jen/Majlis area can be one site

Encourages governmental collaboration and efficiency

Already near the waterfront, easily reached by major streets, etc

Based on Public Policy Lab's "Old City and Capital District" concept paper